

Phase 0 Launch Gates

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Phase 0 launch gates

Updated: 2 October 2026 (AEST). P0 means Phase 0: prove a small, controlled reuse/refurbishment operation before offering general public intake or larger IT asset disposition (ITAD) services.

This is the canonical action sequence. The expanded checks are designed operating policies, not evidence that the premises, insurance or licences have been approved. Current decision: external gates remain open. Do not advertise general public intake. See CURRENT-STATE.md (CURRENT-STATE.md). Creating this checklist does not close a gate. [EVD-P0-013-015]

How to use this page

Make two separate decisions:

1. Operation ready? All nine intake gates must support the actual site and scope before accepting a business intake. A known donor or free device does not automatically remove these gates.
2. This item acceptable? Each device still needs authority, hazard, category, data/lock, route and capacity checks. Assess a batch item by item.

Study, synthetic records and practice on personally owned devices without others' private data can continue within the current-state boundary (CURRENT-STATE.md). That does not authorise public collection. Existing stock intended for business resale must pass section 2; already owning it is not sale-release approval.

Unknown, waiting for reply and verbal-only answers leave a gate open. A genuinely non-applicable requirement needs a recorded basis. Use a private copy of the readiness and capacity record (../templates/phase-0-readiness-and-capacity-record.md). Keep private correspondence, lease documents, donor/buyer identities, serial lists and site-security details out of this public repo.

1. BLOCKS INTAKE

These are pass conditions. If one fails, the proposed intake does not proceed. Written closure is this project's conservative policy, not a claim that every home business legally needs a development application or every insurance product below.

First: describe one consistent operating model

Give Council, the landlord/agent, insurer and Fair Trading the same dated scope. An answer for online selling alone may not cover device collection, storage and dismantling.

Detail | What the scope must say

Operator | Legal person/entity, trading name, who owns stock and receives sale proceeds.

Premises | Exact address and specific work/storage area, existing use, floor area, access and simple zone plan. Keep the address private here.

Hours/arrivals | Proposed Tuesday/Saturday intake; appointments or walk-ins; actual maximum appointments/day, people/visit, vehicles, parking and handoff location.

Equipment | Categories, maximum items/batch and simultaneous stock/weight/value; donation, purchase or customer-property custody.

Work | Inspection, cleaning, wiping, low-voltage testing, named component replacements and any dismantling.

Sales/exit | Online sales, pickups, postage/transport, parts reuse, residual destinations and storage time.

Exclusions | No unattended dumping, loose/damaged lithium, unknown mixed loads, shredding, mains repair or unconfirmed hazardous streams in P0.

Fill in actual numbers before requesting advice; example limits in older research are not approvals. Access to another business's tools does not establish permission to use its premises, licence, insurance or customer-data arrangements.

P0-I01 — Council has classified the exact use

Meaning: Council has considered the described receiving, storage, repair/reuse, dismantling, selling and visitor model at this property. NSW home-enterprise guidance has a conditional exemption pathway; it does not determine this proposal. [S01-S02; EVD-P0-001-002]

Do before intake:

- [] Send the scope and zone/capacity plan to Dubbo Regional Council planning. Ask whether it is exempt development, requires consent/approval, or is not permitted there.
- [] Ask about planning/building, waste activity, fire/access, parking, signage, noise/storage conditions and any further authority referral.
- [] Obtain any required issued approval and implement its conditions before the affected activity starts.

Evidence that closes it: dated written, property-specific advice matching the model; any required issued approval; and evidence its conditions are met. Council offers general duty-planner enquiries and a written-advice route. Advice and development consent are different documents.

Not enough: a generic “home businesses are fine”, an application awaiting a decision, or another operator's approval. If blocked: change premises/scope and obtain the relevant answer.

P0-I02 — Lease/landlord position permits the activity

Meaning: planning legality and tenancy permission are separate. Permission for online sales may not cover stock, batteries, customer devices, shed use or visits. NSW rental-business guidance says to check the rental agreement and necessary approvals. [S03; EVD-P0-003]

Do before intake:

- [] Review the signed lease, extra terms, outbuilding restrictions and any relevant body-corporate rules against the scope.
- [] Resolve uncertainty with the agent/landlord and tenancy advice where needed. Obtain necessary written consent or agreed variation.
- [] Confirm allowed storage, access, visitor handoff, modifications/security changes and reinstatement obligations.

Evidence that closes it: relevant terms and any necessary permission/variation for the actual activity and area; or a supported reason additional consent is not required. No finding about this particular lease is made here.

If blocked: use suitable permitted premises or narrow/reassess the activity. An employer's premises is not automatically an approved alternative.

P0-I03 — Workspace is dry, secure and suitable

Meaning: valuable equipment and possible private data can be kept without water ingress, unsafe testing or unauthorised access. This is a site inspection, not a requirement to buy an industrial workshop. Use Research 12 (RESEARCH-12-PREMISES-PHYSICAL-FLOW-CAPACITY.md) and the safety SOP (RESEARCH-06-BATTERY-ELECTRICAL-WORKSHOP-SAFETY.md). [S04; EVD-P0-004, 013]

Do before intake:

- [] Inspect rain/leaks, damp/condensation, contamination, unstable/overloaded shelves, trips and exits; resolve defects.
- [] Provide restricted locked storage for unwiped devices and removable media, separate from sale-ready stock.
- [] Label receiving, restricted hold, safe test/repair, sale-ready and outbound positions. Keep customers and children out of work/data zones.
- [] Assess lighting, ventilation, leads/chargers, task-appropriate electrical equipment and emergency access. Refer electrical defects/mains work to a competent licensed provider as applicable.
- [] Run a dummy arrival-to-dispatch with a healthy personally owned device; reconcile its label, record and physical position.

Evidence that closes it: private inspection/photos and zone plan, resolved defect list, measured capacity and successful dry run. Not enough: “looks dry today” despite known leaks. Fail action: no resale stock or unwiped client devices in the unsuitable area.

P0-I04 — Insurance matches the actual work

Meaning: relevant cover is in force for the declared activities, with understood limits, excesses, exclusions and conditions. Standard home cover often excludes business activity. A general liability quote does not answer every device/data risk. [S05; EVD-P0-005]

Ask the insurer/broker to map exposures to policy wording:

Exposure | Specific question

Stock/custody | Owned devices versus customer property: theft, fire/water and accidental damage; valuation and storage limits?

Testing/repair | Exact charging, cleaning and component-replacement work; workmanship or care/custody/control exclusions?

Visitors | Appointments, home-site handoffs and buyer pickups covered under the declared arrangement?

Batteries | Healthy embedded lithium cover; quantity, charging/storage conditions and damaged-item exclusions?

Transit | Collections, business vehicle use, carrier transport and downstream handoff: whose cover applies?

Resale/product liability | Injury/property damage from sold refurbs/chargers; remedies and recall costs covered or excluded?

Privacy incidents | Lost unwiped devices, accidental exposure and response costs; separate cover required?

- [] Retain the insurer's written response, schedule/endorsements and relevant wording; confirm commencement and implement required conditions.
- [] Resolve important gaps or remove the affected activity from the scope. Do not dismiss a relevant risk just because the policy excludes it.

Evidence that closes it: an exposure-to-cover map with references and resolved restrictions. This is a risk-review policy, not a claim that every listed cover is mandatory by law. Not enough: a brochure or unpaid quote promising “business insurance”.

P0-I05 — Fair Trading classification and hold workflow are resolved

Meaning: determine whether this acquisition/refurbishment/resale model requires a second-hand dealer licence or fits an exemption. NSW guidance covers electronic goods and includes a recycling-program exemption; its application to this project remains unresolved. Where the retention rule applies, guidance requires a 14-day hold on notified premises without alteration, subject to exceptions. [S06-S07; EVD-P0-006-007]

Do before intake:

- [] Give Fair Trading the full scope: donated/purchased devices, household/business sources, refurbishment, parts harvesting and resale. Request a written applicability answer and basis.
- [] If required, obtain the licence for the correct entity and implement current supplier-ID, records, reporting, premises, display and retention rules. A pending application does not authorise prescribed-goods trading. [S06]
- [] Ask which actions are allowed during any hold: visual inspection, power-on testing, erase/reset, drive removal, RAM/SSD replacement, disassembly, return or transport; confirm the clock and urgent safety exceptions.
- [] Translate the answer into separate custody, legal-hold and data-hold fields, with a supported release decision.

Evidence that closes it: model-specific written classification, required licence/exemption/conditions and a worked dummy record demonstrating permitted work and release timing.

Pending-answer policy: do not acquire a new business batch under an unresolved model. For stock already in custody, secure it and seek instructions. Do not assume wiping, repair or disposal is permitted simply because 14 days elapsed. A stock-review deadline cannot override a legal hold. This repo does not decide whether wiping legally counts as alteration.

P0-I06 — Battery screen and emergency response are usable

Meaning: P0 receives only screened devices with no battery red flags; it does not offer loose/damaged lithium collection. FRNSW says never use/charge damaged batteries or put them in normal waste/recycling or ordinary battery collection points. [S08; EVD-P0-008]

Do before intake:

- [] Put red flags on the offer form and receiving checklist: loose lithium, swelling/bulging case, leaking, puncture/crushing, water/liquid ingress, fire/smoke exposure or abnormal heat.
- [] Use the battery SOP (RESEARCH-06-BATTERY-ELECTRICAL-WORKSHOP-SAFETY.md). Healthy devices are charged with appropriate equipment/supervision under the site plan; no unattended/overnight charging.
- [] Record the evacuation route, assembly point, working phone and site address privately; practise with photographs or a healthy dummy device.
- [] Confirm a specialist advice/disposal path for a hidden defect discovered after acceptance.

Emergency: smoke, vapour, hissing, fire or immediate danger means stop, keep people away, evacuate, call 000, and follow emergency instructions. Do not make carrying, dismantling, improvised containment or driving the device elsewhere the default response. [S09; EVD-P0-009]

Evidence that closes it: site-specific procedure/contact plan, logged dummy drill and specialist route. A generic fireproof box is not closure. Battery safety isolation is different from the locked administrative/data-hold shelf.

P0-I07 — Each accepted category has an exit if it fails

Meaning: there is a real destination if repair/resale fails, not merely a hoped-for buyer. Downstream means the receiver after this workshop: return recipient, reuse/parts buyer, specialist media handler or recycler.

- [] Complete the partner validation record (../templates/partner-validation-record.md) for each stream/condition in scope.
- [] Confirm business/refurbisher eligibility, categories, condition, quantity limits, fees, bookings, packaging/transport and refused-load rules.
- [] Define data clearance for whole devices and parts; ordinary recycling acceptance is not evidence of secure drive destruction.
- [] Record receiver, current written terms, expected handoff evidence and review date. Remove a category if its only exit disappears.

Evidence that closes it: populated route register and current receiver confirmation for each accepted stream; agreed return terms for assessment/customer property. EPA household CRC guidance excludes businesses, so do not use a resident drop-off service as the business backstop. [S10; EVD-P0-010]

Boundary: refusal does not guarantee that a dangerous item is safe for its presenter to transport. Active danger follows the emergency plan; a non-emergency referral needs receiving-provider instructions.

P0-I08 — Records distinguish authority, custody and data state

Meaning: every item can be tied to its source, permitted actions and location. A transfer of ownership and a repair/assessment custody arrangement are different. “Someone left it here” is not authority.

- [] Use the custody form (../templates/asset-transfer-and-chain-of-custody.md), triage fields (../templates/triage-fields-addendum.csv) and reject log (../templates/triage-reject-log.csv), plus statutory fields confirmed under I05.
- [] Before acceptance, record source/contact privately; authority/transfer basis; asset ID; make/model; serial/IMEI if present (otherwise missing); intake time; battery/safety, data and management/account state; acceptance/reason; allowed work; route and location.
- [] Treat unknown storage as UNWIPED — RESTRICTED. Record wipe/destruction authority and legitimate owner/admin lock removal. Do not collect passwords or browse personal files.
- [] Link devices, chargers, removed drives and parts; log moves; protect private records and prove a synthetic backup can be restored.

Evidence that closes it: synthetic accept/refuse/hold/release cases with every item/media accounted for and private access/recovery checked. Follow the data SOP (RESEARCH-05-DATA-IDENTITY-PRIVACY-SOP.md). Deleting files or fitting a new SSD does not account for the old drive; secure disposal is device/media-specific. [S11; EVD-P0-011, 014]

P0-I09 — Capacity is measured and cannot overflow

Meaning: 20-30 is the cumulative pilot sample, not simultaneous storage permission. Capacity includes physical positions, legal/data holds, labour/supervision, approved/insured limits and outbound bookings. Count existing business stock and customer property too.

- [] Fill the zone capacity table (../templates/phase-0-readiness-and-capacity-record.md): labelled positions, item/weight limits, occupancy/reservations, review/age limits, owner and overflow action.
- [] Reserve a position for every incoming device and its accessories/media before booking. Exits, aisles and safety exclusion areas are not inventory space.
- [] Apply actual site/permission limits, not illustrative numbers. Check the pending batch against every relevant constraint, including mandatory holds.

[] Reconcile stock on each workday; review overdue items and confirm available work time and the next outbound booking.

Example, not a site limit: six secure unwiped positions exist and five are occupied. A three-device batch cannot fit even with an empty bench. Split/reschedule it or clear stock through a permitted route. Do not move a legally held device merely to free a slot.

Evidence that closes it: populated capacity table, first-batch reservations and dummy overflow decision. Hard stop: no labelled place, full relevant zone, overdue unresolved stock, no lawful outbound capacity or no supervision. No overflow into the yard, living areas or emergency area. [EVD-P0-015]

Immediate decisions: refuse, defer, hold or emergency

Finding | Before custody transfers | If discovered after acceptance

Uncertain authority/suspicious identity | Defer/refuse until evidenced. | Stop processing/release; secure item/records; seek applicable owner/regulator/police instructions. Return to the presenter is not automatically lawful.

Unsafe battery, electrical hazard, active liquid/mould | Refuse normal intake; no power-on. Active danger is an emergency. | Stop work; use site-specific safety response and specialist advice, not ordinary bench/storage.

Unresolved MDM/Autopilot/Activation Lock/FRP for intended reuse | Owner/admin clears before normal reuse intake; no bypass offer. | LOCK HOLD; obtain legitimate removal or the authorised parts/data/recycling route; no usable-device listing.

Missing record, unclear data or media identity | Complete/defer before acceptance. | DATA HOLD; no release or personal-file browsing; reconcile and apply data SOP.

No route, capacity or in-scope category | Refuse/reschedule that item even in an otherwise eligible batch. | Pause the affected lane; resolve permitted return/outbound without breaching holds or safety controls.

An administrative hold is for a physically safe device needing lawful authority/data/lock/hold resolution. Record custody basis, reason, owner, review date and exit. It does not authorise accepting an obviously unsafe item or bypass the normal refusal policy. [EVD-P0-013-015]

2. BLOCKS RESALE

Intake approval is not sale approval. Each unit needs its own release check. The data, safety and traceability boundary also applies to donation/community handoff.

Release gate | What “done” means | If it fails

Ownership/legal status | Complete transfer/authority; licence/hold conditions and release timing resolved. | Hold; no sale/donation/parts transfer while prohibited.

Storage sanitisation | All media identified; approved media-appropriate method, tool/version, result, verification, date/operator and evidence. Removed drives have their own recorded outcome. | Restricted failed/inaccessible media goes to approved destruction/referral. A new SSD does not clear the old HDD.

Accounts/enrolment | Owner/admin removal and clean setup checked for that exact device. | No working-device listing; authorised return/parts/recycling only after legal/data gates.

Tests/safety | Completed bench sheet (bench-test-sheet.md); faults, charger/battery and relevant recall checks recorded; work within competence/cover. | Repair within scope or route out. Disclosure does not make an unsafe product acceptable.

Software support | Exact model/OS support, eligibility and licence basis checked against current sources. | Choose legitimate supported software/route or a permissible disclosed limitation; no unsupported security claim.

Grade/accessories | Actual functional/cosmetic grade, battery findings, charger/accessories and limitations match the unit. | Correct listing; battery percentage is not a safety certificate.

Economics | Include acquisition, parts, consumables, active labour, payment/platform, packing/shipping and remedy reserve. | Reprice/change channel or choose parts/recycling using measured costs.

Buyer terms/traceability | Listing/warranty checklist (LISTING-WARRANTY-CHECKLIST.md), defect disclosure, accurate claims, remedy/contact process and private sale record. | Correct before listing; full identifiers stay private.

Never claim “certified data destruction”, “military grade”, “NIST certified” or “AS 5377 certified” without exact supporting evidence. An internal log is not third-party certification. Use the data SOP (RESEARCH-05-DATA-IDENTITY-PRIVACY-SOP.md), resale research

(RESEARCH-04-RESALE-PRICING-CHANNELS-RETURNS.md) and sale/recall record(../templates/sale-and-recall-record.md). [EVD-P0-014]

3. CAN LEARN DURING PILOT

Once intake gates close for the chosen scope, process 20–30 known-authority items in capacity-fitting batches. No public dumping, damaged lithium, unknown mixed loads or untracked private data. Review after cumulative items 5, 10, 20 and 30.

Pre-register categories/source, labour budget, spending ceiling, stock/hold limits, routes and review criteria in the pilot tracker (../pilot-tracker.csv) and first-30-device plan (FIRST-30-DEVICE-EXPERIMENT.md). Commercial thresholds can be learned in a bounded experiment; premises/data/safety controls cannot be deferred to it.

Question | Measure

Is intake selective enough? | Offers/accepts/refusals and reasons; accepted items later found unsuitable; reviewed refusals possibly reusable.

What is reused? | Final unit routes: sold, donated, parts, returned, recycling; keep repair/unsold/unresolved stock visible.

Where does time go? | Active identify/wipe/test/repair/clean/list/pack/travel minutes, separately from elapsed hold/shelf days.

What fails? | Battery, lock, OS and failed-wipe rates by source/category, plus costs/consequences.

Does resale pay? | Actual receipts less costs/reserve, active hours, days-to-sale, returns/warranty events. Asking prices are not revenue.

Do residuals leave? | Linked device/media/parts records; outbound count/weight, receiver receipts, fees and rejected loads.

Is repeat demand real? | Follow-up interest and written pilot terms; no assumed supply contracts/community commitments.

Pause: uncontrolled safety/data incident, missing custody item, capacity breach, repeated authority ambiguity or lost safe exit. Record/contain the cause under the SOP, resolve it and recheck affected gates before restarting. A failed batch is evidence, not a reason to increase volume to recover sunk costs. [EVD-P0-015]

4. LATER / SCALE-UP

These change the model. Do not buy or promise them before pilot results and scope review support them:

Expansion | Revisit before starting

Public walk-ins, broad household or unattended drop-off | Planning/tenancy/visitor conditions, dumping prevention, contamination, staffing and residual capacity.

Loose batteries, CRTs/hazardous streams | Competence, site/fire controls, receiving/transport terms, insurance and approvals.

Industrial dismantling/shredding | Land use/waste permissions, plant/data/environmental controls and viable volume.

Warehouse, vehicle lease, staff/volunteers | Proven workload/cash flow, premises/transit cover, employer duties, training and controlled data access.

Institutional volume/full ITAD branch | Contract authority, security/service obligations, certification scope, custody and residual capacity.

Device Bank/Good360/community commitments | Actual recipient agreement, suitable supported devices, release checks and remedy/support/funding responsibilities.

Sanitisation under another firm's certification | Written entity/site/operator/process arrangement and exact permitted claims.

Scale only when stock clears within limits, measured labour meets the chosen target and residual terms remain current. Set a new scope version and re-close affected gates before expansion. [EVD-P0-015]

Evidence, sign-off and reopening

Each gate needs owner, status, scope version, evidence source/date/location, conditions, next action, review/expiry trigger and sign-off. A durable call note is a lead; it does not replace written closure or an issued approval/policy.

Reopen affected gates after changes to premises, lease, entity, category, quantities, visitors, work/data access, cover or receiver. Check physical/safety/capacity on each intake day and scope/routes before each batch.

Minimum go/no-go packet: completed scope; I01-I09 evidence; capacity/route tables; first-batch offers/reservations; successful synthetic accept/hold/refuse/release drill. Sign-off supports only that bounded model. Track maturity/next actions in Research 16 (RESEARCH-16-CLOSURE-EVIDENCE-REGISTER.md).

Sources and evidence boundary

Checked 2026-10-02. General sources do not establish this property's approval, cover, licence or partner agreement. Evidence records are in data/evidence.yamll (../data/evidence.yaml); EVD-P0-013-015 record the proposed design.

ID | Primary source | Supports

S01 | NSW Planning Portal: home enterprises (<https://www.planningportal.nsw.gov.au/development-and-assessment/planning-approval-pathways/exempt-development/home-based-enterprises>) | Conditional exemption framework.

S02 | Dubbo Council: application process (<https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/builders-developers/overview-of-application-process/understanding-the-da-process>), written advice (<https://eservice.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/eservice/councilLink.do?resource=PlanningadviceTerms.html>) | Enquiry/advice pathways, not approval.

S03 | NSW Small Business Commissioner: rental business (<https://www.smallbusiness.nsw.gov.au/help/common-questions/running-a-home-business-from-your-rental-property>) | Lease/approval checks.

S04 | SafeWork NSW: hazards/risks (<https://www.safework.nsw.gov.au/legal-obligations/employer-business-obligations/managing-hazards-and-risks>) | Identify/control/review risks.

S05 | Business.gov.au: home business (<https://business.gov.au/planning/business-structures-and-types/home-based-businesses>), insurance management (<https://business.gov.au/risk-management/insurance/manage-your-business-insurance>) | Home cover limits and policy conditions.

S06 | NSW dealer licences (<https://www.nsw.gov.au/business-and-economy/running-a-business/industry-specific-business-requirements/pawnbrokers-and-second-hand-dealers/pawnbroker-and-second-hand-dealer-licences>) | Electronic goods, exemptions, pending applications.

S07 | NSW dealer obligations (<https://www.nsw.gov.au/business-and-economy/running-a-business/industry-specific-business-requirements/pawnbrokers-and-second-hand-dealers>) | Retention/alteration/notified premises.

S08 | FRNSW: damaged batteries (<https://www.fire.nsw.gov.au/fire-safety/home-fire-safety/battery-and-charging-safety/what-should-i-do-if-my-battery-is-damaged>) | Damage flags and use/charging/disposal restrictions.

S09 | FRNSW Charge Safe (<https://www.fire.nsw.gov.au/fire-safety/home-fire-safety/battery-and-charging-safety/files/chargesafe.pdf>) | Evacuate, stay out, call 000.

S10 | NSW EPA: CRCs (<https://www.epa.nsw.gov.au/Your-environment/Recycling-and-reuse/household-recycling-overview/community-recycling-centres>) | Business waste excluded from household CRCs.

S11 | ACSC: device disposal (<https://www.cyber.gov.au/protect-yourself/securing-your-devices/how-secure-your-device/how-dispose-your-device-securely>) | Device/media-specific data handling, not certification.